Forsyth County News

Your "Hometown Paper" Since 1908

Vol. 88, No. 132 **WEDNESDAY** NOVEMBER 5, 199

*01 F006130 03/23/98
GO DAWGS!!!
NEWSPAPER GEORGIA
* UNIVERSITY OF GEORGIA

ATHENS GA 30602



Skies will be cloudy.
Highs in the 60s.
Lows in the 30s.

THIS ISSUE

Copyright © 1997 Forsyth County News

Opinion



Cartoonists' views on the news.
Page 14A

Sports

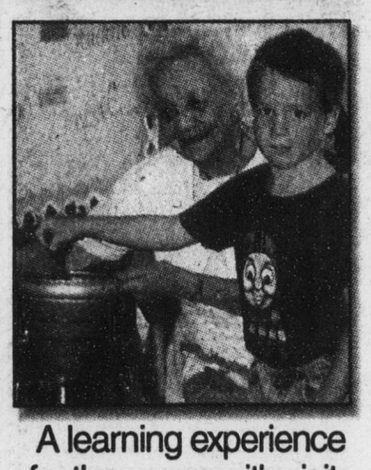


North boys and girls CC third at state; South, Central do well, too
Page 1B

LAKE LANIER LEVELS

Date	Level
Oct. 31	1067.32 ft
Nov. 1	1067.34 ft
Nov. 2	1067.41 ft
Nov. 3	1067.48 ft
Normal	1071.00 ft

Schools



A learning experience for the young with visits to share for elders.
Page 8-10A

INDEX

Abby....12A
Classifieds....6B
Community....5A
Deaths....2A
Events....13A
Horoscope....12A
Legals....3B
Opinion....14A
Schools....8A
Sports....1B

COMING FRIDAY

ENTERTAINMENT SECTION

TV programming, Soap Opera Updates, Critics Corner, Jill Jackson's Hollywood, more all in Friday's edition.

Missed paper policy:
For a replacement paper call 8 a.m. to 6 p.m. Wednesday and Friday, and 9 a.m. to 1 p.m. on Sunday – **887-3126.**

90994 04001

Commission to hire public safety director

By Sheri Toomey
Staff Writer

Members of the county firefighters' paid staff and volunteers walked out of Monday's commission meeting incensed after a 4-1 vote to hire a public safety director.

Commissioner Andy Anderson made the motion which drew the lone "no" vote from Commissioner John Kieffer.

Anderson said he discussed the idea with Fire Chief Norris Bennett Monday to ask for his support and his commitment to stay on as fire chief.

"This is a progressive move as we go into a full-time paid fire department," said Anderson.

Thirty full-time firefighters were approved for the 1998 budget by the commission.

The public safety director will report to the board chairman and oversee emergency management services and the fire department.

Bennett said he did not support this decision and was not sure he would remain as fire chief.

"I am not very happy right now," said Bennett.

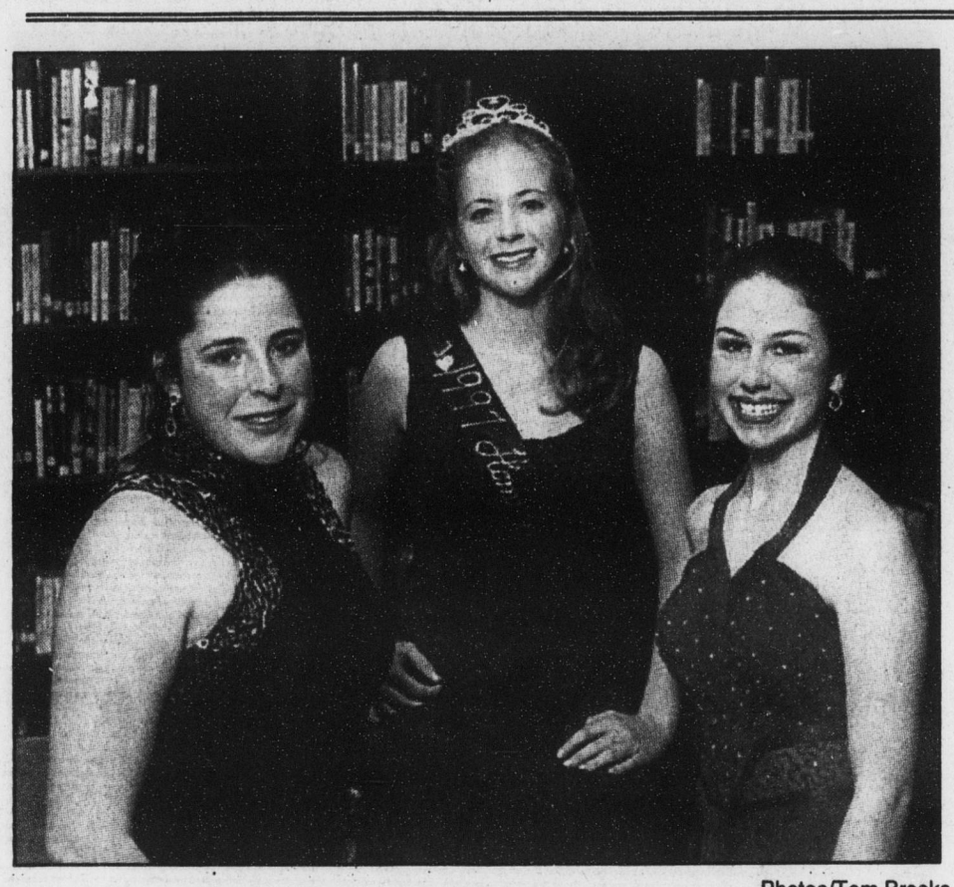
Commissioner John Kieffer raised several objections before the vote and stated the board's first move in January was to abolish several positions, including the personnel director, but was now adding a high-salary position to the staff.

Kieffer said the board had not fully discussed the issue and listed Fulton, Gwinnett and Cherokee counties as those without a public safety director while Cobb had one to oversee emergency medical services, E-911 and both the police and fire department.

Battalion Chief Tommy Coleman said the commission was sneaking issues in through the back door.

"This is dirty politics at its absolute worst," said Coleman, who noted the volunteers had already voiced their opposition to the closed-session demotion of Bennett twice.

See ***HIRE***, Page 2A



Photos/Tom Brooks

South Forsyth High Homecoming honors
While rain dampened the photo opportunities at South Forsyth High School's Homecoming on Halloween night, Kristen Abernathy (center) was crowned as queen. Heidi Mullinax was second runner-up and Brooke Talamo was first runner-up. Photographer Tom Brooks made photographs the following day.

County, city seeking advice from regional planning professionals

By Sheri Toomey
Staff Writer

County and city officials Monday night agreed to employ the Georgia Mountains Regional Development Center for advice on overlapping services.

House Bill 489, passed in the last session of the Georgia General Assembly, requires county and city governments to meet before 1998 regarding these issues.

Pending results from this study by the GMRDC and county and city administrative staff, the city and county will proceed with plans for the next special sales tax referendum.

Cumming Mayor H. Ford Gravitt said all city services are provided without any city-assessed property tax but were instead paid by income from business licenses and property tax rollbacks.

As a formality, both the city and county agreed to split the proposed Special Purpose Local Option Sales Tax funds with 85 percent going to the county and the remainder to the city.

County Administrator Stevie Mills, who has already begun a list of services provided by the county, will set up the next meeting between the county and the city regarding services and the SPLOST referendum.

The next referendum proposed for March of 1998 would generate $100 million dollars over a five-year period for numerous projects.

Gravitt stressed that funds must be used for the specific purposes listed on the referendum.

Commissioner John Kieffer mentioned allocating funds for a central recreation center to be used by all county residents.

See ***ADVICE***, Page 2A

Frady reward fund grows

By Michael Kurtz
Staff Writer

Reward funds which have been set up for information leading to the arrest of the killer of 11-year-old Levi Frady are growing.

During its called meeting Monday, the Forsyth County Board of Commissioners voted unanimously to give another $2000 to the reward fund.

Chairman Bill Jenkins said the board is supporting law enforcement any way they can, and he hopes a reward will help solve the crime.

Gov. Zell Miller allocated $2,000 to the reward fund. Also, Dawson County Sheriff Billy Carlisle said about $3,500 in donations has been received through his office. Forsyth County Sheriff Denny Hendrix said his department has another $7,000 in reward money for what he describes as the department's top-priority case. Money has been collected from private businesses and concerned citizens.

The father of the Forsyth County Middle School sixth grader could be home Wednesday for the first time in nearly three weeks.

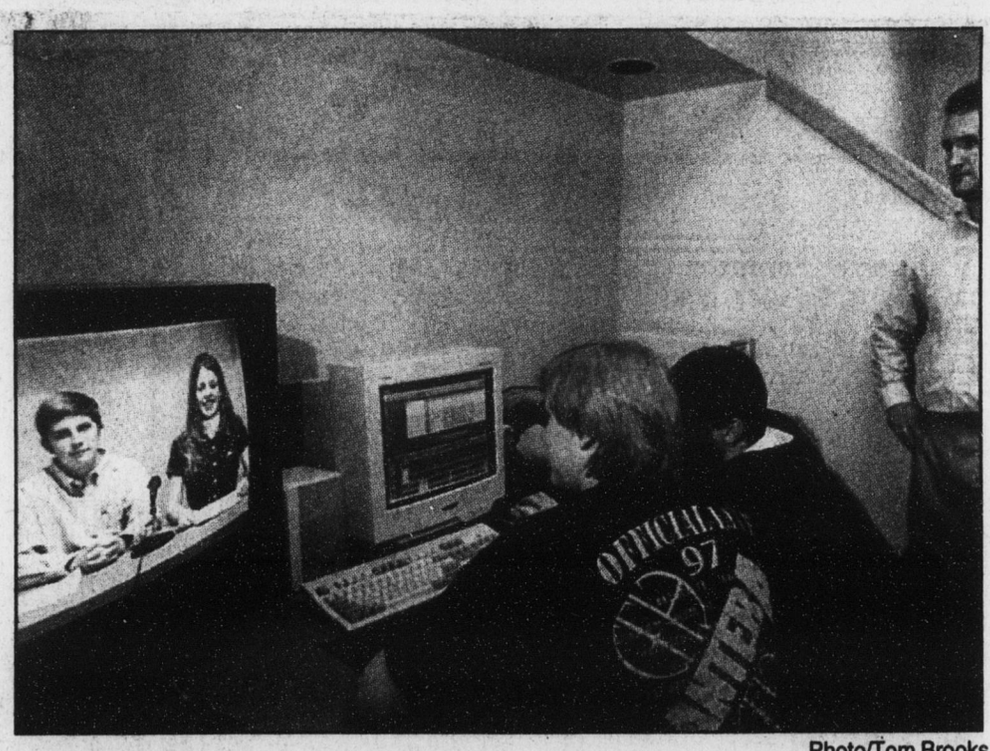
Forsyth County Clerk of Courts Doug Sorrells said the courts are waiting for a motion from Milton Frady's attorney, Michael Hauptman, for a possible bond hearing Wednesday morning.

Frady turned himself in to the Forsyth County Sheriff's Office Oct. 29 and has been in custody since.

Frady is being held on bench warrants stemming from a 1994 burglary charge.

But investigators from the Forsyth and Dawson County sheriff's departments and the Georgia Bureau of Investigations wanted to question Frady about the Oct. 22 murder of his son.

See ***REWARD***, Page 2A



Photo/Tom Brooks

James Seawright oversees production of video in Forsyth Central's lab setting.

Seawright gets teaching honors

By Lisa Renzi
News Intern

James Seawright, Forsyth Central Teacher of the Year and Sallie Mae First-Year Teacher honoree, makes a difference in more areas than just inside the classroom.

Seawright takes the time to make sure students he encounters have a solid foundation in which to build their future careers.

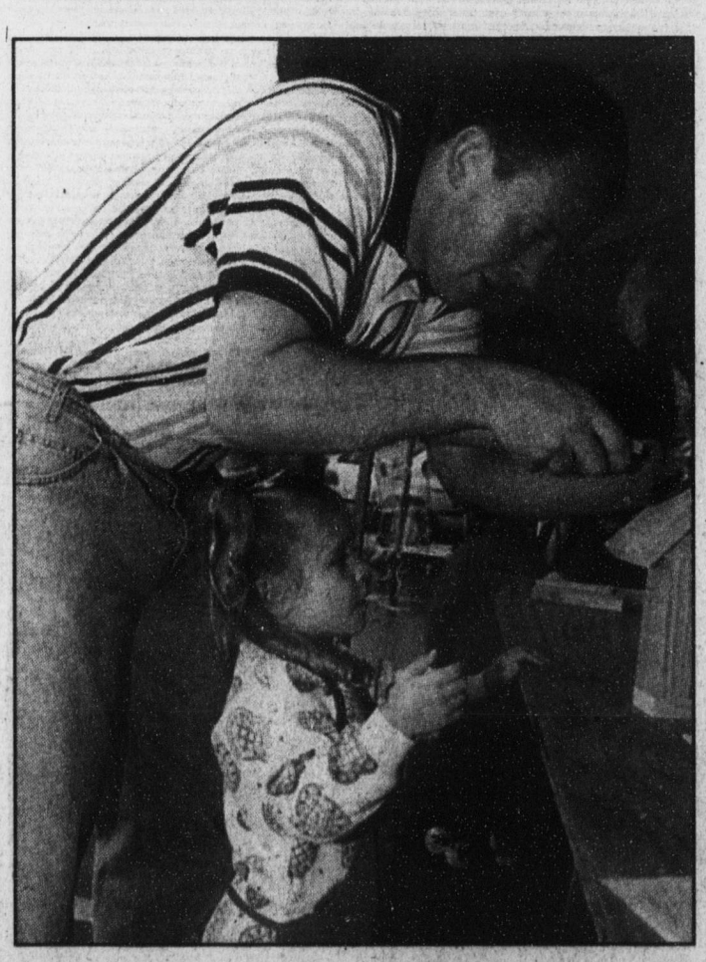
Seawright, technology and video teacher, makes an impact in more ways than simply explaining the latest computer program or instructing a student how to use the latest editing devices. His instruction goes far beyond normal classroom techniques, and the recent awards exemplify the definition of a truly great teacher.

"These awards have a great deal of meaning to me. It really means a lot to know that the whole school is behind you, and this award is great after just graduating from school," stated Seawright. Not only do these honors show that the faculty of Central stands behind him, a Sallie Mae nomination is an honor, and Seawright was a state semi-finalist.

Seawright's dedication is evident to anyone who simply takes a walk around his classroom. In one section, students use the robotic arm to complete a multitude of tasks. In another area, the latest video editing devices are in use by others. Students have the opportunity to run the latest computer programs, participate in the actual filming of school events, take part in the "film studio" that exists in the classroom or participate in a variety of other hands-on activities. The technology department of Forsyth Central shows students having fun and learning about possible careers.

Jordan Ellis, a junior, in Seawright's class, says, "Mr. Seawright has helped me discover new areas in the technology field and has even shown me a possible career. His expertise in computers has shown through as he has taught me so much about them." Ellis is not alone in his respect for Seawright, who finds each of his classes is completely full. Students were turned away due to overwhelming student demand.

Kenny Foxx, principal of Forsyth Central, sums up Seawright's contributions. "James is an excellent teacher. He adds expertise and advanced knowledge to the classroom, and he is involved in the entire school."



Home training from Dad

Andrea Barney got a little "Home (Depot) training" from her dad, Dean Barney during Saturday's Kids' Workshop at Home Depot. Children had a chance to get some hands-on experience with hammers and nails while constructing small birdhouses. Firefighters were also on hand for fire safety talks and demonstrations. More pictures in the Nov. 9 Home Improvement III section.

Photo/Chris Pugh